

MICHELE VALINOTI

PhD Candidate in Economics at NYU

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Economics PhD candidate with expertise in causal inference, machine learning/AI, and NLP. Skilled at applying advanced methods to diverse domains and eager to leverage new technologies to solve real-world problems.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Uber | San Francisco, CA (USA)

PhD Scientist Intern (Membership Team)

Jun – Aug 2025

- **Model Deployment:** Deployed and refined a membership model by building SQL ingestion pipelines, scaling estimation in PySpark, and delivering automated reporting for stakeholders.
- **Communication:** Delivered results and insights to cross-functional teams (PMs, Engineers, Scientists).

New York University | New York, NY (USA)

Graduate Researcher and Teaching Assistant

2020 – 2026

- **Large-scale Data Analysis:** Assembled and structured large novel datasets and applied econometric techniques, including panel regressions, difference-in-differences.
- **Structural Estimation:** Estimated a two-stage model of lobbying choices and access (contacts) under legislator attention constraints; used counterfactuals to quantify effects on access and grants.
- **Natural Language Processing:** Built a candidate-linked corpus (electoral records and 1M+ news articles) and measured gender differences in political coverage by decomposing embedding gaps into topic vs. stylistic treatment.
- **Large Language Models:** Developed scalable LLM pipelines for 250K+ municipal ordinances, and handwritten historical records, integrating batch APIs, prompt engineering, and fine-tuning.
- **Teaching:** Served as teaching assistant for undergraduate, master's, and PhD-level courses; supported instruction, designed assignments, and coordinated teamwork activities.
- **Writing and Presentation:** Wrote 4 research papers, and presented research in internal seminars to academic audiences.

Graduate Research Assistant

2022 – 2025 (part-time)

- **Causal Inference:** Replicated regression discontinuity studies to validate a discontinuity-detection algorithm.
- **Geospatial Analysis:** Constructed terrain slope datasets for US counties and assisted in first-stage instrumental variable strategy.
- **Model Optimization and Simulation:** Optimized Julia/Python solvers to compute market equilibria and estimate structural parameters; implemented parallelized bootstrap simulations at large scale.
- **Statistics:** Assisted in the statistical theory and implementation of bounding the extent of selection bias in a structural model.

European Central Bank | Frankfurt, Germany

Risk Analyst Intern

Jan – Jul 2020

- **Risk Monitoring:** Ran daily and weekly monitoring tasks, identified potential flags, and communicated with stakeholders at national central banks.

EDUCATION

PhD and MPhil, Economics

2026

New York University, USA

MA, Economics

2019

Collegio Carlo Alberto, Italy

BSc, Physics | MSc, Stochastics and Data Science

2019

University of Turin, Italy

SKILLS

Coding: Python (*pandas*, *scikit-learn*, *PyTorch*, *Hugging Face*), Julia, R, SQL

Tools: Git, $\LaTeX$, PySpark

Languages: English (fluent), Italian (native)